

SIGNATURE TALENT

Theo Blackwood, Dealmaker

EXECUTIVE



HIRE

◆ 5

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Commit this employee to poach an opponent's employee. (Pay its Hire plus 2 Surplus. It gains Non-compete and arrives committed.)

Has never met an executive he didn't try to hire, usually at dinner, usually from your table.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 210 / 386

OFFICE LOCATION

Grand Bahama

OFFICE LOCATION



OPEN

◆ 3 branch only

Regulation

Headquarters or Open as a branch.

At the start of your turn, gain 1 Surplus for every 3 Assumed Reinsurance funding sources you control, rounded down.

The treaties cross oceans with the paperwork already in order.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 365 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Whole Life

LIFE



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity ▼ Inflation

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Lifelong coverage plus a savings account, plus a sales pitch for both.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 001 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Term Life

LIFE



CAPACITY

◆ 1 Leverage a turn

MARGIN

● 1 run start

STAPLE

▲ Mortality ▲ Low Interest Rates ▼ Longevity

Staple: any number per deck.

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

Coverage for a set term that most customers outlive, which is the business model.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 003 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 009 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Pension Risk Transfer

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▼ Inflation

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A company hands you its pension promises, keeping the logo while you keep the retirees.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 009 / 386

STABLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 386

STAPLE FUNDING SOURCE

Fixed Annuity

ANNUITY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

0

run start

STAPLE

▲ Longevity

▲ Low Interest Rates

▲ Rising Interest Rates

▼ Mortality

Staple: any number per deck.

Guaranteed checks for the customer; interest-rate nightmares for you.

A

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 010 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Captive Fronting Program

SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Regulation

▲ Liquidity

▲ Credit

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A borrowed license on the front, someone else's risk in the back, collateral in between.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 026 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Captive Fronting Program

SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Regulation

▲ Liquidity

▲ Credit

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A borrowed license on the front, someone else's risk in the back, collateral in between.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 026 / 386

FUNDING SOURCE

Captive Fronting Program

SPECIALTY

CAPACITY

1

Leverage a turn

MARGIN

1

run start

▲ Regulation

▲ Liquidity

▲ Credit

If uncommitted at the start of your turn, gain its Margin before refreshing.

A borrowed license on the front, someone else's risk in the back, collateral in between.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 026 / 386

INVESTMENT

Private Equity

ILLIQUID

COST

3

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 054 / 386

INVESTMENT

Private Equity

ILLIQUID

COST

3

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Your maximum hand size is 1 higher.

Destroyed if a Liquidity Stress Test hits you.

No distributions yet, which the fund calls the J-curve.

S

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 054 / 386

INVESTMENT

Litigation Finance

ILLIQUID

COST

◆ 2

YIELD

● 1 each turn

ILLIQUID

▲ Regulation ▼ Litigation

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Whenever a Litigation Stress Test resolves, gain 1 Surplus.

When claims severity rises, someone funds the lawsuit.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 066 / 386

INVESTMENT

Private Credit Fund

ILLIQUID

COST

◆ 5

YIELD

● 3 each turn

ILLIQUID

▲ Credit ▼ Rising Interest Rates

Illiquid: can't be liquidated.

Destroyed if Dash for Cash, Northern Rock Bank Run, or Great Depression hits you.

Marked to model, quarterly.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 073 / 386

RISK MANAGEMENT

Short Sale

RESPONSE

COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Play only against a Market Stress Test. Gain 3 Surplus.

Schadenfreude: German for enjoying someone else's portfolio falling.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 128 / 386

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Industry Lobbying

RESPONSE

COST

◆ 3

SIGNATURE

RESPONSE

Signature: one copy per deck; Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Stop a Regulation Stress Test that hits you.

The trade association would like to submit four hundred pages of comments.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 131 / 386

SIGNATURE RISK MANAGEMENT

Too Big to Fail

TREATY

COST

◆ 3

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

If you become insolvent, every other company loses 5 Surplus. If all remaining players become insolvent because of this, you win the game.

What regulators call interconnectedness, your rivals call a hostage situation.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 142 / 386

TALENT

Chief Financial Officer

EXECUTIVE

HIRE

◆ 4

Once each turn, you may turn up to 3 Leverage into Surplus, one for one.

Turns leverage into capital and capital into a slide for the board.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 201 / 386

TALENT

Treasurer

RISK & COMPLIANCE

HIRE

◆ 2

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 3 of your loss from its Liquidity clauses.

Knows where every dollar is at 4 p.m., and where it has to be by 9 a.m.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 211 / 386

TALENT

Compliance Patsy

RISK & COMPLIANCE

DARK

HIRE

◆ 1

DARK

Dark: Stress Tests can charge for it on your board or in your discard pile.

Commit this employee during a Stress Test to prevent up to 5 of your loss from its Regulation or Litigation clauses. Then fire this employee.

Signed everything, read nothing, and is available to start immediately.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 219 / 386

SURPRISE INSPECTION

Margin Call

LIQUIDITY

COST

◆ 4

HITS

Target opponent

ESCALATE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Volatility

Escalate: pay 2 more to hit every opponent instead.

Target opponent loses 4 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 2 per Volatility exposure, and 2 per investment they control.

The broker would like a word, and also your cash.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 282 / 386

Risk Analytics Desk

DATA



PRICE

◆ 1

Once each turn, after you play a treaty or cover, your next investment this turn costs 1 less Leverage (minimum 1).

A smaller downside leaves room for the next idea.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 383 / 386

Contingency Plan

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: or draw on your turn.

Choose one; discard this after use.

On your turn: draw 2 cards, then discard 1. OR as a Response:

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

Useful today. Possibly indispensable tomorrow.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 174 / 386

Contingency Plan

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 1

RESPONSE

Response: or draw on your turn.

Choose one; discard this after use.

On your turn: draw 2 cards, then discard 1. OR as a Response:

Prevent up to 4 loss to you from this Stress Test.

Useful today. Possibly indispensable tomorrow.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 174 / 386

Scenario Rehearsal

ACTION - YOUR TURN



COST

◆ 2

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

On your turn, privately look at the next 2 shared pile cards. Return them in either order, then discard this. Developing and delayed Stress Tests still happen first.

The disasters are still coming. The order is negotiable.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 175 / 386

Emergency Run-Off

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 0

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Before taking loss, discard an uncommitted funding source with capacity, and its covers. Keep at least one capacity source. No new funding next turn. Once per company per resolution; stages and replays are separate.

Save the company. Give up part of the business.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 176 / 386

Emergency Run-Off

RESPONSE



COST

◆ 0

RESPONSE

Response: play while a Stress Test is being run.

Before taking loss, discard an uncommitted funding source with capacity, and its covers. Keep at least one capacity source. No new funding next turn. Once per company per resolution; stages and replays are separate.

Save the company. Give up part of the business.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 176 / 386

Cancer Cured

LONGEVITY



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Longevity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 12 Surplus per Longevity exposure.

Champagne in the lab, followed by a very quiet meeting in annuity reserving.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 253 / 386

Affordable Care Act

REGULATION - AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Regulation exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

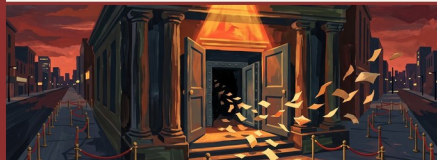
In March 2010, the Affordable Care Act became law and rewrote the rules of American health insurance. Every four years, half the actuaries update their assumptions and the other half update their resumes.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 256 / 386

Northern Rock Bank Run

LIQUIDITY - AS-IF REPLAY, 2007



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Liquidity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Liquidity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure. Then each company discards half its Retail Deposits, Venture Deposits, and Evergreen Credit, rounded down.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Junk Bonds, Private Credit Fund, or Feeder Fund it controls.

In September 2007, Northern Rock sought emergency support as wholesale funding dried up. Depositors queued outside its branches.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 275 / 386

Basel III Endgame

REGULATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 2023



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Regulation

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Regulation exposure, plus 5 more. Then each company discards a card.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Rated Feeder Note it controls.

In July 2023, U.S. regulators proposed the Basel III endgame, which would have raised big banks' capital requirements by about 16%.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 281 / 386

Chainsaw AI at Sunbeam

CORPORATE · AS-IF REPLAY, 1996



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 3 Surplus. Then each company fires each of its employees with Hire 3 or less.

In 1996, Sunbeam hired AI Dunlap, known as Chainsaw AI, who cut half its workforce; the profits that followed later had to be restated.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 286 / 386

Morris Worm

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 1988



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber ▲ Short-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Cyber exposure and 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure. Then each company discards a card.

In November 1988, a graduate student's self-copying program ran out of control and crashed about a tenth of the computers on the internet. The internet was smaller then.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 266 / 386

Flash Crash

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2010



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Short-Term Equity exposure and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

On May 6, 2010, a burst of automated selling briefly wiped about a trillion dollars off the value of U.S. stocks. The Dow fell almost 1,000 points in minutes, then mostly came back.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 290 / 386

1973 Oil Crisis

INFLATION · AS-IF REPLAY, 1973



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Inflation ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Rising Interest Rates

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Inflation exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 4 per Rising Interest Rates exposure.

In October 1973, Arab oil producers cut off exports to the United States and other countries, quadrupling oil prices and setting off years of high inflation.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 268 / 386

Asbestos Claims

LITIGATION



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD DEVELOPING EVENT

▲ Litigation

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped; Developing Event: all stages this round, each with a response window.

Stage 1. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 2. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

Stage 3. Every company loses 4 Surplus per Litigation exposure.

The exposure was decades old, and the claims kept coming for decades more.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 298 / 386

AI Bubble Bursts

MARKET



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity ▲ Short-Term Equity ▲ Volatility

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 8 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure, 4 per Short-Term Equity exposure, and 2 per Volatility exposure.

After losses, each company hit discards every AI card and every investment named Meme Stock it controls.

It was three laptops in a trench coat the whole time.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 271 / 386

Zero-Commission Price War

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2019



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 2 Surplus. Then each company commits 2 of its available funding sources.

On October 1, 2019, Charles Schwab cut its online stock trading commissions to zero, and its biggest rivals matched within days.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 293 / 386

2003 European Heat Wave

MORTALITY · AS-IF REPLAY, 2003



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE ACT OF GOD

▲ Mortality ▲ Health Price

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 4 Surplus per Mortality exposure and 4 per Health Price exposure.

In the summer of 2003, a heat wave killed more than 70,000 people across Europe, most of them elderly. The forecast called it a week in advance, and the emergency rooms filled anyway.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 240 / 386

AWS S3 Outage

CYBER · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Cyber

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 6 Surplus per Cyber exposure, plus 3 more. Then each company discards a card.

On February 28, 2017, a mistyped command knocked Amazon's S3 storage offline for about four hours, and Amazon's status page could not show it, because it ran on S3.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 291 / 386

Iowa Derecho

NAT CAT · AS-IF REPLAY, 2020



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

ACT OF GOD

▲ Nat Cat

Signature: one copy per deck; Act of God: can't be stopped.

Every company loses 2 Surplus per Nat Cat exposure.

On August 10, 2020, a derecho crossed Iowa with winds up to 140 mph, flattening corn, grain bins, and most of the trees in Cedar Rapids.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 346 / 386

Cape Wind Abandoned

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2017



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Long-Term Equity

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 10 Surplus per Long-Term Equity exposure.

In December 2017, after sixteen years of fights with its neighbors, the company behind Cape Wind, planned as America's first offshore wind farm, gave up. Nothing got built.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 263 / 386

Klarna's Down Round

MARKET · AS-IF REPLAY, 2022



HITS

Every company

SIGNATURE

▲ Credit

Signature: one copy per deck.

Every company loses 5 Surplus per Credit exposure.

In July 2022, Klarna, Europe's biggest buy now, pay later lender, raised money at a valuation 85% below its peak a year earlier. Four easy payments, then the fifth, the sixth, and the collections calls.

ALPHA EX MACHINA

NO. 312 / 386